TC091 / Top500 rank 91

Stop reaching for the joke

Pause before performance.

1. Forced humour often protects the speaker, not the listener.
2. A laugh can be politeness, pressure, fear, or discomfort.
3. Do not make pain, shame, status, or vulnerability the punchline.

Humour is optional; dignity is not.

TC091 - Forced-humour restraint: front + back

TC091 / Top500 rank 91

Use warmth instead

Choose care, clarity, or quiet.

1. Replacement line: I do not want to make light of that.
2. Motive check: connection, relief, approval, defence, status, or avoidance?
3. Repair line: That was a miss. Let me answer properly.

Repair impact once, then return attention to the other person.